

The Optimal Number of Naps

Findings from a subject who slept through the study

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\$ The problem

Nobody agrees on how many naps a day is correct. We asked the only expert on the subject and he fell asleep during the question.

- Recruit one dog.
- Watch him for a week.
- Write down every time he stops moving.

01 The instrument

In practice

\$ Two ways to count a nap

Strict

- Eyes fully closed.
- Tail completely still.
- Survives one doorbell.

Generous

- Eyes mostly closed.
- Tail negotiable.
- He looks comfortable, so it counts.

\$ One pass of the counter

```
def count_naps(dog, hours):  
    return [h for h in hours  
            if dog.is_horizontal(h)]
```

Caveat

Sitting upright with both eyes closed remains contested.

The instrument

02 In practice

\$ A well-behaved subject

The method requires a subject who stays put. This one is world class.



\$ What it costs him

Naps

Hours

asleep

3

4.1

stirring

11

9.8

doorbell